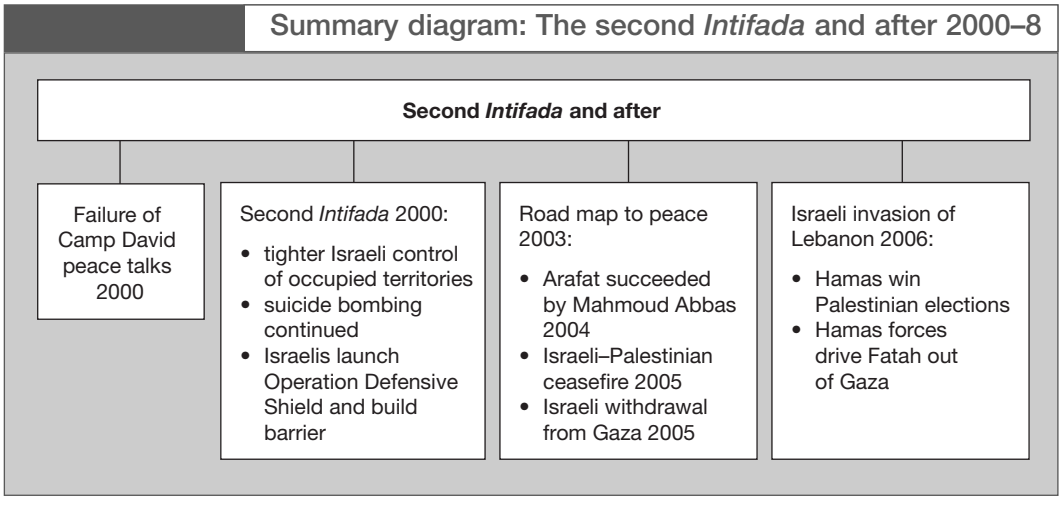
barrier; many Israelis are happy for the Palestinians to have a state of their own as long as it is enclosed. But a settlement dictated by one side will not bring lasting peace.

The main issues remain the same as ever:

- the borders of any Palestinian state
- the Jewish settlements on the West Bank
- the future of Jerusalem
- the Palestinian refugees' right to return.

Both sides have much to gain from discussion and negotiation but it will require great courage from their leaders. Syria will also have to be brought into the peace process. Unlike Egypt and Jordan, Syria has never made a peace treaty with Israel. Syria has still not regained the Golan Heights which Israel captured in 1967.

Above all, peace-making will require the wholehearted support of the US government. The USA is the only country that can put enough pressure on Israel to reach a negotiated settlement with the Palestinians and, at the same time, assure the Jewish state of its protection. The USA supplies Israel with over $3 billion of aid every year as well as the most advanced military equipment. Therefore it has huge influence in peace-making.

Only when peace between Israel and the Palestinians is secure will the threat from terrorism, in both the Middle East and the world as a whole, be reduced.

Summary diagram: The second *Intifada* and after 2000–8